

# Turning Point Magazine

*—Transforming Everyday—*

▶ CONCEPT NOTE ◀





# Executive Summary

Turning Point magazine is a dynamic quarterly publication conceived in November 2023 by a team of professional volunteers with diverse expertise spanning IT, social work, sexual and reproductive health and rights (SRHR), environmentalism, health, education, agriculture, and business. This group came together with a shared vision: to amplify the voices of grassroots communities and shine a spotlight on impactful stories of change in a global ecosystem where such narratives often remain unheard.

Through a commitment to pro bono services, these professionals created a digital-first platform that bridges critical gaps in storytelling, collaboration, and actionable solutions. The magazine leverages offline and online campaigns to foster intergenerational dialogue, promote life-based programmes, and inspire innovation in addressing pressing challenges.

With its origin in Kenya, Turning Point magazine not only celebrates the country's rich cultural heritage, including collaborations with the vibrant *matatu* industry, but also aims to target the broader African regional bloc and make waves on the global stage. The platform positions itself as a resource for cross-sectoral partnerships, offering insights, success stories, and strategies that resonate with stakeholders across the NGO, corporate, donor, and government sectors.

To deepen its impact, the magazine plans to engage various industries including the beverage sector to champion responsible health practices, sustainable development, and inclusive progress. By harnessing the power of storytelling and collaboration, Turning Point magazine is committed to fostering meaningful dialogue and advancing solutions that address today's complex challenges.

## Vision

To be the leading platform in driving positive change, fostering inclusivity, authenticity and innovation for a future of shared success.

## Mission

Empowering individuals and communities through inclusive, transformative and inspiring content that elevates grassroots voices and celebrates humanitarian impact.

## Rationale of Turning Point

Turning Point magazine seeks bridges, the gap between diverse sectors, creating a dynamic platform for collaboration, knowledge-sharing, and sustainable development. By addressing the unique needs of NGOs, businesses, governments, donors, and communities alike, it facilitates meaningful dialogue and fosters collective action. The magazine not only amplifies voices that often go unheard but also provides actionable insights that drive positive change at the local, national, and international levels. Through its wide-reaching content, Turning Point is committed to inspiring progress and empowering stakeholders to make a lasting impact on society.

## Key Features of Turning Point Magazine

Turning Point magazine is designed to serve as a bridge between NGOs, private sector institutions, government entities, embassies, donors, and other key stakeholders across various sectors. The magazine provides actionable insights, celebrates innovative solutions, and fosters collaboration among these diverse sectors. Its dynamic content addresses global challenges and highlights the impact of cross-sector partnerships.

## Feature articles

This section delves into stories of transformation and impact across all sectors, from NGOs driving grassroots change to private sector companies executing effective CSR programmes, and governments implementing public policies for societal progress. These articles should provide thought leadership on solving key global and local issues, as well as actionable strategies for strengthening collaboration between NGOs, private enterprises, government bodies, and embassies.

## Example topics

*Driving Change Through Public-Private Partnerships*

*Transforming the Future of Development: The Role of Donors, NGOs, and Government*

*Corporate Social Responsibility in Action: How Business is Changing Lives*

## Creativity corner

This section celebrates creativity as a tool for social change, spotlighting how various sectors—NGOs, businesses, governments, and embassies—use innovative communication and engagement strategies to drive impact. Through art, storytelling, digital media, and creative advocacy campaigns, organizations can increase awareness, mobilise resources, and build meaningful connections.

## Insightful interviews

Featuring leaders, innovators, and change-makers across sectors, this section provides unique perspectives on the challenges and opportunities that shape today's global development landscape. Interviews with executives from NGOs, private sector leaders, government officials, donor organisations, and embassies should shed light on trends, emerging solutions, and cross-sector collaborations. The aim of these interviews is to inspire critical thinking and collaboration for sustainable progress.

## Example topics

- Public and Private Sector Collaboration: A Conversation with Leading Innovators
- The Role of Donors in Strengthening Civil Society: Insights from Global Philanthropists
- Diplomacy and Development: How Embassies Are Driving Local Impact

## Wellness and lifestyle

Understanding the pressures faced by professionals across all sectors, this section offers practical advice on mental health, well-being, and work-life balance. It emphasises self-care and sustainable lifestyle choices for those working in high-stakes environments such as NGOs, corporate settings, government offices, and diplomatic missions. It also addresses the importance of fostering a supportive workplace culture to prevent burnout and encourage resilience.

## Example topics

- Mental Health in the NGO Sector: Coping with Stress and Burnout
- Building a Culture of Well-being in Corporations and Government Offices
- Wellness Practices for High-Impact Professionals in Diplomacy and Development

## Tech and innovation

Technology is reshaping how all sectors NGOs, governments, private enterprises, and donors operate. This section explores technological innovations that enable more efficient, transparent, and scalable solutions across these sectors. From data management tools and digital platforms to innovations in project monitoring and evaluation, this section showcases how technology can amplify impact and foster collaboration.

### Example topics

- Leveraging Technology for Effective Collaboration Between NGOs and Government
- Digital Solutions for Scaling Private Sector Impact in Development
- Innovations in Monitoring and Evaluation: The Future of Development Projects

## Target Audience

Turning Point magazine is designed to resonate with a broad coalition of stakeholders spanning the NGO, private, public, and international sectors. It will serve as a vital resource, providing actionable insights, inspiring success stories, and innovative strategies that drive sustainable impact. The added value to each of these sectors is as follows:

**Government institutions:** The magazine will offer a unique perspective for government bodies, with a focus on grassroots impact and community-based development. It will help policymakers understand the real-world effects of their decisions while also showcasing effective models of public service delivery. Turning Point will facilitate dialogue between the public and private sectors, offering practical recommendations and lessons learned to inform policy-making and enhance service delivery at both national and local levels.

**Non-governmental organizations (NGOs):** The magazine will act as a powerful platform for knowledge exchange, featuring best practices, success stories, and real-world examples of transformative change. By showcasing impactful community-driven initiatives, it will help NGOs to gain visibility, build credibility, and foster collaboration across sectors. Turning Point also will offer critical insights into the challenges and opportunities facing NGOs, helping to shape more effective strategies and interventions.

**Private sector and corporate entities:** Turning Point magazine will engage the private sector by highlighting opportunities for corporate social responsibility (CSR) that align with community needs. It will demonstrate how businesses can play a pivotal role in sustainable development through strategic partnerships, innovation, and shared value creation. The magazine also will offer valuable insights into market trends, policy developments, and corporate philanthropy, providing a roadmap for businesses looking to make a measurable difference in the communities they serve.

**Donors and development partners:** For donors and development partners, the magazine will provide transparency and accountability by offering evidence of the tangible impacts of their investments. It will showcase the outcomes of funded initiatives, providing data-driven insights and success stories that help inform future funding decisions. By amplifying the voices of communities and projects, Turning Point will enhance donor confidence and foster a deeper understanding of the challenges and solutions in the development sector.

**Volunteers and change agents:** Turning Point will serve as a source of inspiration and motivation for volunteers and change agents by showcasing the profound impact of their work. It will offer a platform for personal stories and highlight opportunities for deeper engagement, helping to connect volunteers with organizations that align with their passions and values. The magazine will also emphasise the importance of volunteerism in driving social change, encouraging others to get involved and make a difference.

## Distribution Channels

### Subscription fees

Turning Point magazine will be available in both digital and print formats. Subscribers can expect exclusive content, early access to issues, and discounts on events and merchandise. Subscription fees will vary to allow accessibility while sustaining the magazine's financial model.

### Advertising

Strategic advertising will support Turning Point's mission and values. Advertisements will be placed thoughtfully to introduce readers to brands and products that resonate with the publication's message and audience.

### Events and merchandising

In addition to the magazine, **Turning Point** will host events and workshops that foster community, learning, and collaboration. Events will range from digital forums and interactive Q&As with featured interviewees to in-person workshops. Turning Point-branded merchandise will also be available, further strengthening reader connection and support.

### Marketing Strategy for Turning Point Magazine

To effectively promote Turning Point magazine and engage our target audience across sectors, we will implement a robust and integrated marketing strategy, combining both offline and online campaigns. Our goal is to reach a diverse, dynamic audience that includes NGOs, private sector, government, donors, embassies, and corporate organizations, while also amplifying the voices of communities, particularly marginalised groups.

### Offline campaigns

Our offline campaigns will focus on engaging sectors that have direct access to large audiences and can facilitate grassroots-level conversations. We will specifically target:

**PSV (public service vehicle) sector:** By leveraging the extensive reach and popularity of the PSV sector in Kenya, we will partner with *matatu* operators, bus companies, and their drivers to spread awareness of the magazine. This will include distributing flyers, posters, and branded materials in high-traffic areas such as bus terminals, taxi ranks, and major routes. We will encourage discussions on social change, community development, and the role of different sectors in driving progress.

**Beverage Sector:** Collaborating with beverage companies, we will place Turning Point magazine's marketing materials in key locations such as retail outlets, restaurants, and bars, where consumers gather. Branded campaigns, joint promotions, and partnerships with beverage brands will help increase visibility, foster positive brand association, and create opportunities for joint cause-driven marketing.

### Online Campaigns

In the digital space, we will leverage multiple platforms to engage our audience, increase visibility, and drive subscriptions. Our online campaigns will include:

**Webinars:** Hosting expert-led webinars on relevant topics such as sustainable development, NGO best practices, and cross-sector collaboration. These webinars will encourage real-time engagement and provide valuable content to our target sectors.



## Target Goal:

Our marketing efforts aim to achieve 1 million subscribers annually, with continuous growth in both offline and online engagement. By combining high-traffic offline campaigns with the strategic power of online platforms and influencers, Turning Point magazine will establish itself as a leading voice for social impact, innovation, and cross-sector collaboration in Africa and beyond.

## Future Outlook of Turning Point Magazine

Turning Point magazine is will position itself to evolve into a vital platform for driving long-term change and sustainability across key sectors, including NGOs, private enterprises, government agencies, donors, embassies, and the corporate world. Looking ahead, the magazine will play a central role in fostering cross-sector collaboration, promoting sustainable development practices, and offering actionable insights to address the world's most pressing challenges.

As a forward-thinking publication, Turning Point will continue to spotlight impactful initiatives that prioritise environmental sustainability, social equity, and economic resilience. By featuring success stories from diverse sectors, the magazine will not only celebrate transformative achievements but also provide a roadmap for integrating sustainable solutions into everyday practices. A core focus will be on promoting eco-friendly innovations, sustainable business practices, and policy shifts that encourage responsible resource use and environmental stewardship. It will highlight how organizations and governments are leading efforts to tackle climate change, conserve natural resources, and create a circular economy.

Through in-depth features, creative advocacy, and expert interviews, Turning Point will build a community of thought leaders, change-makers, and organizations committed to sustainability. It will continue to amplify marginalised voices and the contributions of young people, women, and community members, ensuring that sustainability efforts are inclusive, equitable, and community-driven.

As Turning Point magazine grows its influence across Africa and internationally, it will remain committed to enhancing collaboration among diverse stakeholders, leveraging innovative technologies, and promoting sustainable development practices to ensure a brighter, more resilient future for all.

### Venue

Nairobi Safari Club, Hotel  
(Lilian Towers)

### Date

Friday, November 29th 2024  
From 6:00pm - 9:00pm

### Participants

High-level representatives from the Permanent Secretaries' Office, UN agencies, local embassies, private sector leaders, NGO executive directors, and key media personalities.

### Language

Forum communications will put into consideration needs for language translation and disability accessibility needs.